SIMETICONE

Not absorbed
Infant colic

CHEMICAL NAME Mixture of polydimethylsiloxane (dimeticone) and silicon dioxide
CLASS Antifoaming agent (antiflatulent)
TRADE NAMES Infacol · Gas-X · Espumisan · Mylicon

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Flatulence, bloating, abdominal discomfort from gas.
- Infant colic (wind) — evidence limited.
- Before endoscopy/ultrasound to reduce gas bubbles.
- Often combined with antacids.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Lowers **surface tension of gas bubbles** → small bubbles coalesce and are passed more easily (belching or flatus).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** chewable tablets (chew well), capsules or drops after meals and at bedtime.
- Infant drops before each feed.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Very rare: mild GI upset, nausea.
- Constipation (rare).

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hypersensitivity (rare).

DOSAGES

- **Adult & ≥12 yr:** 125–250 mg after meals and at bedtime as needed (US max-strength label: ≤250 mg/24 h unless a doctor advises).
- **Infant drops (20 mg/0.3 mL):** <2 yr 0.3 mL; >2 yr 0.6 mL, after feeds/meals and at bedtime (max 12 doses/day).
- **Before endoscopy/imaging:** professional use per unit protocol.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- Suspected bowel obstruction or perforation.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- May ↓ absorption of levothyroxine (separate doses).

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** minutes.
- Not absorbed — excreted unchanged in faeces.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess abdominal distension and pain to exclude serious causes.
- Infant colic: support parents; check feeding technique.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Chew tablets thoroughly.
- Give drops before infant feeds.
- Seek help for vomiting, blood in stool, fever or a hard swollen tummy.

KEY POINTS

- Antifoaming agent; breaks gas bubbles.
- Infant colic and bloating.
- Not absorbed; very safe.
- Before imaging.

SOURCES CHECKED **[576]** CVS Health Infant Gas Relief, oral (US label) **[577]** Mylicon Infants Gas Relief Dye Free, oral (US label)
Full references p. 432–457